

The US-Iran War, Round Two

Iran over-performed in the first six weeks of this war. Expect the Americans to dominate once the ceasefire ends.



PREDICTIVE HISTORY

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This week there was yet another brief sliver of hope that this war would come to an end. Trump said that the war could end “very soon,” and Israel entered into a ten-day ceasefire with Hezbollah. The Iranians opened the Strait of Hormuz. Oil prices dropped, and someone with impeccable timing yet again made hundreds of millions shorting oil. Once the markets closed on Friday, Trump said that “we’re going to have to start dropping bombs again.” Israel broke the ceasefire in Lebanon, and Iran closed the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump is signaling a long war. He has asked for a \$1.5 trillion dollar budget for the Pentagon, and the young men of America will be automatically registered for the draft starting in December. The Pentagon has asked Ford and General Motors to start manufacturing drones and munitions, which suggests that America is moving towards a war-time economy.

Congress continues in its dereliction of duty. The Senate has now failed four times to pass a resolution demanding that Trump seek Congressional approval to continue the Iran war. The House of Representatives failed by a **theatrical one vote** to pass the same resolution. Four Republicans abstained from voting, and Thomas Massie voted in favor. This forced the Democrats to sacrifice one of their own to deny the resolution, and Jared Golden (who does not plan to seek re-election) became the scapegoat.

Iran's Trump card was its capacity to disrupt the global economy by depriving it twenty percent of its energy and one-third of its fertilizer. In ordering a blockade of Iran's blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, Trump has raised the ante. Who will blink first?

The global economy cannot wait out this game of chicken. These past forty-five days there have been at least forty-five oil refineries catching fire. The Geelong refinery "accident" in Australia is particularly suspicious, and devastating for a nation that has 30 days of jet fuel. Prime Minister Albanese considered it a major triumph when he secured 570,000 barrels of diesel from Brunei and South Korea. This will keep the Australian economy running smoothly for **thirty-six hours**.

Exhaustive List of Hydrocarbon & Major Energy Incidents (Non-Middle East)

Date 	Facility	Location	Nature of Incident	Known Impact
15 Apr 2026	<u>Viva Energy Geelong Refinery</u>	Geelong, Victoria, Australia	Significant fire & explosions	One of Australia's two remaining refineries; impact under assessment.
14 Apr 2026	<u>Vedanta Sakti Plant</u>	Chhattisgarh, India	Massive boiler explosion	16–19 fatalities reported ; dozens injured.
09 Apr 2026	<u>Pemex Olmeca Refinery</u>	Dos Bocas, Mexico	Fire in coke storage area	Second fire in a month; limited to storage unit.
07 Apr 2026	<u>Bhilai Steel Power Plant-2</u>	Chhattisgarh, India	Turbine explosion & massive fire	7+ injuries ; workers seen jumping from buildings to escape.
04 Apr 2026	<u>Lukoil-Nizhegorodnefteorgsintez</u>	Kstovo, Russia	Drone strike and fire	Strike on crude distillation unit; significant throughput reduction.
03 Apr 2026	<u>ONGC Mumbai High Platform</u>	Offshore Mumbai, India	Sudden fire on SHP platform	10 workers injured ; operations briefly suspended.
03 Apr 2026	<u>Primorsk Port Infrastructure</u>	Leningrad, Russia	Multiple drone/air strikes	Fires at major oil export terminal and storage depots.
23 Mar 2026	<u>Valero Port Arthur Refinery</u>	Texas, USA	Severe explosion & fire	Diesel hydrotreater and central control room destroyed.
12 Mar 2026	<u>LyondellBasell Bayport Plant</u>	Texas, USA	Major industrial fire	Targeted hydrocarbon feedstock processing units.
05 Mar 2026	<u>Petromax Refining</u>	Channelview, Texas, USA	Pump seal failure & fire	Quick containment; minimal offsite impact.

01 Mar 2026	<u>Esmeraldas Refinery</u>	Esmeraldas, Ecuador	Fire in SEVIA unit charge pumps	60-day state of emergency declared due to infrastructure damage.
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Why did Iran agree to the ceasefire? Why give America the time to assemble its ground forces? Why put Iranian diplomats in harm's way? Why give the Iranian people false hope? The outcome was obvious once Trump agreed to all of Iran's conditions.

The geo-political analyst George Friedman believes that China, Pakistan, and other Iranian "allies" have forced Iran to negotiate. They know that America is a bully who has launched an unprovoked war of aggression, and is an arsonist who is lighting on fire the world's oil reserves. But the world cannot pressure either an arrogant empire or a genocidal ethno-state, and so they pressure Iran. Pakistan is the public mediator, and China is the elder statesman nudging Iran behind the scenes.

The GCC thought they could stay neutral in this conflict, and now the UAE and Saudi Arabia are committed to Iran's downfall. Both understand that if America were to depart the region, they — and not Israel — would incur Iran's wrath.

The desperation of the world means that America has the license to employ a three-pillar strategy to break the will of the Iranian nation, and force a political settlement:

- Strangle Iran economically.
- Foment ethnic divisions.
- Suffocate Tehran.

Once the George HW Bush arrives in theater, America will have sixty-thousand soldiers to deploy against Iran. This is not that many, but if

used strategically they could prove devastating. Expect a multi-vector assault on Iran's coastline, and expect US marines to seize Kharg Island and Qasem Island. The United States cannot control the Strait of Hormuz to restore free maritime navigation, but they can deny Iran's capacity to export oil as well as collect tolls. This will force Iran to increasingly rely on financing from China, which is incentivized to see this war end as quickly as possible.

Once the US marines are able to establish forward operating bases in Iran, ethnic insurgent groups (such as the Kurds and the Balochs) will be motivated to take up arms, and carve out their own sovereign territory within Iran. With American aerial supremacy and special forces as support, these groups will be an effective spearhead.

The main focus will be to methodically diminish Tehran's water supply, power plants, and the transportation grid that brings food to feed a city of ten million. Many will hear this, and shout out: "But it's a war crime to target critical civilian infrastructure!"

To this I have a one-word answer: "Gaza."



We were too focused on the barbarity of the genocide to appreciate that evil can be strategic and calculating.

Consider America's War on Terror, which was mainly a silent war on young Muslim men. In her book *The Dark Side*, Jane Mayer explained that the main justification for extraordinary rendition and torture (to extract information that could foil terrorist plots and save innocent lives) did not hold up to scrutiny. The FBI had a tried and true method of extracting information from criminals and terrorists: Ask nicely.

Why did the American military isolate, water-board, and sodomize young Muslim men? Mayer pointed out that the War on Terror's interrogation techniques were heavily influenced by the research of Martin Seligman, who coined "learned helplessness" as a euphemism for "trauma-induced disassociation." The War on Terror was a psychological experiment to test the limits of the human psyche, and to traumatize young Muslims into programmable zombies.

Israel's genocide in Gaza attempted to create "learned helplessness" in a large civilian population. Remember when the Israelis corral the Palestinians to the south of Gaza, and then back up north like cattle? What was the point of that?

In the movie *Cool Hand Luke*, the sheriffs attempt to break Luke's strong-willed personality by having him dig a hole, fill it up, and then dig it again. As Seligman can gleefully tell you, Sisyphian torture will rip the soul out of your body.

The American bombardment of Tehran is not meant to induce a **compliant** population (as was the case with the Palestinians) – it is meant to induce an **angry** population.

We have lived in such a peaceful and prosperous time that we have memory-holed the original purpose of the nation-state, which was to **mass manufacture cannon fodder**. The French Revolution citizen armies flung themselves happily into the slaughter, and this terrified the European monarchs into recognizing the power and potential of the nation-state. Schools and media indoctrinated people into wanting to

kill and die for their nation. Hospitals and science grew the population to sustain large-scale wars.

But nuclear weapons mean nations can no longer fight the devastating wars of the twentieth century, and a new type of warfare will need to be invented for the twenty-first century. **We will see the Americans and the Israelis pioneer this in Tehran by fusing “shock and awe” with the color revolution playbook.** “Shock and awe” will deteriorate the state’s capacity to deliver basic services, especially food, water, and electricity. The color revolution playbook (propaganda, paid protestors, spies infiltrating the security services) will be used to foment anger among the people, and direct this anger at the state.

The true and full horrors of a twenty-first century war have yet to be witnessed. Let us pray for the Iranian people.

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